

Manuela Salazar Iglesias

Data Scientist

Personal Information

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Residence Medellín - Colombia



Profile

Data Scientist and ML Engineer with 5+ years of experience in financial services, e-commerce, healthcare, and consumer goods. Proven ability to lead end-to-end advanced analytics projects from model design to executive stakeholder communication, including a payment recommendation model driving up to \$5M USD in quarterly revenue growth. Experienced across multiple industries at KPMG, Limestone, and Mercado Libre. Skilled in leveraging AI tools and agents to accelerate analysis and decision-making. Master's in Artificial Intelligence from Universidad de los Andes, with research nearing publication.

Work experience

- Apr 2024 – Current **DS Engineer** – Mercado Libre
Develop and maintain ML models for real-time and asynchronous fraud detection across multiple sites and products. Implement AI-driven agents and automation tools to enhance operational efficiency and fraud prevention at scale.
- Jan 2023 – Apr 2024 **Senior Data Analyst** – Limestone Consulting
Led end-to-end Analytics and BI projects for retail clients, including demand forecasting models and inventory optimization solutions. Designed and deployed interactive dashboards in Power BI to support data-driven decision-making across the organization.
- Aug 2023 – Nov 2023 **Open Data Project Lead** – Fundación Corona / Sibsco
Led data collection, preprocessing, and standardization for a national Social Impact program in Colombia, including interactive Power BI visualizations and a sustainability plan for the program's data infrastructure.
- Jan 2021 – Dec 2022 **Senior Data Scientist** – KPMG
Progressed from Data Analyst to Senior Data Scientist in under two years. Led advanced analytics projects across banking, retail, and healthcare, covering the full lifecycle from pre-sales to delivery. Managed client presentations, cross-functional teams, and delivered corporate AI training programs in Python, SQL, and machine learning for enterprise clients.

Formation

- May 2026 **Master's degree in Artificial Intelligence**
Universidad de los Andes
Thesis: Impact of Kangaroo Mother Care on neurodevelopmental outcomes — manuscript under review
- July 2020 **Chemical Engineer**
Universidad Nacional de Colombia

Certifications

ELS American Explorer English Case Western University - Cleveland OH
Power BI: Análisis de Datos y Business Intelligence Udemy Course
SQL for Data Science University Of California Davis Extension (Virtual mode)
Scrum Foundation Professional Certificate (SFPC) Certiprof
DS4A/Colombia 2.0: Graduated with Honors Correlation One

Competencies and Skills

Languages: Spanish (Native), English (B2).
Programming: Python, SQL.
AI tools: Claude, ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, N8N.
Data & ML: Power BI, Tableau, Looker Studio, Spark, BigQuery.
Dev tools: Docker, Git, Office package.